

# An Introduction to the Ionic Framework

Ionic is an advanced HTML5 hybrid mobile application framework. Using Apache Cordova, it can be easily run on mobiles. A big advantage of using Ionic is that the code base remains the same for all mobile platforms and the UI/UX looks like a native mobile platform.



**D**eveloping mobile applications is easy if we are only targeting one platform, but that's not the case with many organisations. Mobile applications for all platforms are difficult to maintain and create, as we need a different code base for each platform (Android, iPhone, Windows), and the UI/UX should be the same for all. Each platform comes with its own set of tools and languages like Java for Android, XCode for Apple and Windows SDK for Windows phones. And each has its own IDE to work on. Instead of building the apps for all platforms separately, many frameworks or tools allow an application to be developed once, to be used on any platform. Usually, this tool or

framework uses HTML and CSS for the UI/UX part.

Ionic is one such framework that uses HTML5 for the UI/UX part. It is built on HTML, JS and CSS, which contain UI elements in different forms to suit specific platforms. Being an HTML framework, we can run the Ionic application in a browser very easily, but to run it on a mobile, Ionic uses Cordova, an Apache product, which allows it to access the native features of mobiles like Contacts, Camera, etc. So, Ionic is a mobile application development framework used to build hybrid apps or mobile applications. It uses HTML5 for developing the mobile applications. A hybrid app is a website running in a browser shell in an app that has access to the